



HUMANITAS
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Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Uvalde Classical Academy
School Website: <https://www.uvaldeclassical.org>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Uvalde Classical Academy (UCA) presents a robust CLASSICAL education profile across its publicly available materials. The school's publicly stated mission, creed, and curricular framework align closely with traditional classical Christian education: formation of virtue and wisdom under a biblical worldview; a Trivium-based curriculum (grammar, logic, rhetoric); engagement with great books and history within a Western canon; and pedagogy that alternates between contemplative, memory-rich elements (chanting, memorization) and Socratic/seminar-based high school inquiry. The school also emphasizes parental partnership, a living-mentors faculty model, and a clear commitment to character formation rooted in Scripture. Overall, the aggregate impression from the materials is a fully CLASSICAL orientation rather than merely "Somewhat Classical." Evidence across religious foundations, purpose, curriculum, pedagogy, faculty, and parent/community engagement supports this conclusion.

Most compelling signals include: explicit biblical/theological framing (Coram Deo, Scriptural worldview, Statement of Faith), a stated Trivium progression (grammar/logic/rhetoric), explicit Great Books and Western-civilization emphasis (and references to "great stories" and "great books"), and a teaching culture described as mentors living the curriculum. The parent partnership and community expectations (parents as co-teachers, open campus, involvement in classroom life) reinforce the classical-community model. The alignment with the Six Essential Elements of Classical Education (Positive/Negative keyword indicators) is strong, with only incidental use of elements that might be seen as non-classical in other contexts (e.g., occasional project-oriented activities) but not dominating the pedagogy.

What would move the needle section is not triggered here, as there are no category results that fall into SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The school's materials appear to meet the core criteria for CLASSICAL across all six categories.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

- **Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Mission emphasizes "godly character according to Scripture"; statements about biblical worldview and Coram Deo; explicit theological content in the Statement of Faith (Trinity, Bible as revelation). Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords from the classical lexicon include truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; Coram Deo; virtue; sacred. The site text aligns with many of these. No explicit negative signals (e.g., relativism) appear in the materials. Why this rating: The school foregrounds theology, virtue, and a sacred sense of education.
- **Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL Evidence:** Claimed formation of virtue and wisdom; focus on virtue, human flourishing, and formation rather than mere information; mission to shape character in a biblical framework; explicit listing of graduate outcomes (virtue, faith, language,

broad literacy). Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include formation, virtue, wisdom, true/good/beautiful (telos of education); liberal education; scholé (conceptually present via formation/restful aims). Negative keywords (e.g., workforce-prep by default) do not appear as the school's primary aim. Why this rating: Formation-focused aims and a claim that education is about virtue and wisdom, not just job prep.

- Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL Evidence: Trivium emphasis (grammar, logic, rhetoric); history woven through curriculum; explicit engagement with great books / Western canon; emphasis on learning through questions and wonder; Latin/Greek and disciplined study appear in the content. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include liberal arts; grammar/logic/rhetoric; great books; history; tradition; wonder; classics; rhetoric; dialectic. Negative signals from the lexicon (e.g., project-based) are not dominant in the school's description. Why this rating: The materials present a canonical classical curriculum with Trivium pedagogy and Great Books/Western-history framing.
- Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL Evidence: Lower grades emphasize singing/chanting, memory work; upper grades feature Socratic discussion, seminars, debates, and rhetoric training; explicit structure around grades K–12 with transitions from grammar to logic to rhetoric; opportunities for memorization, recitation, and public speaking. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive signals include Socratic seminars, narration/recitation, chanting, memory work, liturgical rhythm, and rhetoric practice. Signs of experiential/project-based learning are not dominant; where present, they are not the core pedagogy. Why this rating: The pedagogy combines contemplative memory-work and Socratic/seminar-based inquiry, as expected in classical education.
- Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL Evidence: Faculty described as mentors living the curriculum, model virtue, and serve as living exemplars; portrait of teacher standards and a collaborative, “faculty as core” culture; administration and faculty pages emphasize role modeling and professional formation within a classical framework. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include mentor, living curriculum, portrait of teacher, faculty as living exemplars; collegial/charismatic faculty culture. Negative signals (e.g., purely technical, certification-driven only) are not present. Why this rating: The teacher as exemplar and the emphasis on character and classical pedagogy align with CLASSICAL expectations.
- Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL Evidence: Clear emphasis on parent partnership and the parental role as co-teachers; frequent references to parental involvement, formation of parents, and opportunities for parents to engage on campus; welcome to campus; explicit invitations to read classical-education literature with parents. Positive/Negative keyword analysis: Positive keywords include partnership with parents, parent formation, open campus, family liturgy alignment; negative signals (customer-professional dynamic) are not emphasized. Why this rating: The school treats parents as co-teachers and engages families in the educational formation process.

Aggregate Ranking: CLASSICAL

- Overall assessment: The combination of theological grounding, formation-centered aims, a Trivium curriculum, classical pedagogy (grammar–logic–rhetoric with Socratic inquiry and rhetoric), a living-faculty model, and strong parent/community partnership places Uvalde Classical Academy squarely in the CLASSICAL category. The textual signals align with the Positive Keyword indicators for classical education (truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; wonder; virtue; literature; Great Books; Trivium; Socratic/seminar pedagogy; memory work) and show limited use of Negative indicators (such as exclusively project-based learning). See the Six Essential Elements lexicon for the framework of these keywords and signals.

What Would Move the Needle

- None required based on current evidence. The school already demonstrates a full CLASSICAL orientation across all six categories. If one desired, the school could further emphasize explicit references to “Great Books” and “Great Conversation” as terms in its public materials to reinforce the Canonical framing, and ensure consistent terminology around scholé/wonder across grade bands. However, these would be refinements rather than core changes.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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